



DESCENDED FROM AN ANCIENT PRE-INCA PEOPLE called the

AYACUCHO

BUILDING ON THE PAST

Huari, the Ayacucho (the name means “purple soul”), like the Otavalens, share their name with an Andes region and city. During the colonial era, the territory

Inspiring setting

Inhabitants of a city that features some of the most outstanding colonial architecture in South America, the urban Ayacucho population, like so many others, reflects two main influences—from their Amerindian ancestors and from the Europeans who dominated their land for so long. The craft objects for which they are best known include brilliantly hued textiles, stone and wood carvings, and fine filigree silver.

POSITIVE ATTITUDE

Many crumbling walls in Ayacucho still display faded traces of terrorist graffiti that date from the 1980s. The people are trying hard to move on from these bitter memories, though, and focus their attention on the color and vitality that define their city today.



Ayacucho women wear the bright skirts, white blouses, and felt hats typical of Andes dress.

EASTER LAMB

In the strongly Roman Catholic Ayacucho culture, Easter is the most important celebration, and Holy Week (*Semana Santa*) dominates the life of the people. During this time, the scent of incense is everywhere, prayers are murmured constantly, and solemn processions fill the streets. As her contribution, this young girl is carrying a living symbol of the Lamb of God.

